

Overview

Exercise Waterhole was a national laboratory exercise in 2023. It showed the need for enhanced management of baseline or centralised laboratory stockpiles. In March 2025, a national workshop considered a centralised national laboratory stockpile for emergency animal disease response. Scenario-based activities tested needs and found gaps in reagents and storage. After the workshop, a catalogue of commonly used tests and reagents across the Laboratories for Emergency Animal Disease Diagnosis and Response (LEADDR) network was created.

Project Lead: Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry; Subcommittee on Animal Health Laboratory Standards; Laboratories for Emergency Animal Disease Diagnosis and Response network

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Project Status: Complete

Objective alignment:

- 2 - Improve Australia's preparedness and ability to respond to emergency animal diseases

Activity alignment:

- 2.1 – Implement actions under National Animal Health Surveillance Business Plan and National Animal Health Diagnostic Business Plan.

See more

See previous updates and future actions on the [National Animal Health Diagnostic Business Plan](#).

See more about [Exercise Waterhole](#).

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal/health/animal-plan/project-68>